

OpenClaw API-KEY Configuration

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1. Course Overview

This course will introduce in detail how to configure API-KEY for AI model services for OpenClaw, including the API-KEY application process, two configuration methods (CLI command configuration and configuration file modification), and how to verify if the configuration is successful. After completing this course, you will be able to successfully connect and use various AI major model service providers.

1.1 Course Content

- Understand the types of model service providers supported by OpenClaw
- Master the API-KEY application method
- Learn how to view and verify the status of connected models

2. API-KEY Application

2.1 Recommended Model Service Providers

- OpenClaw supports many model service providers, including:
 - **OpenAI** - GPT series (API + Codex)
 - **Anthropic** - Claude series (API + Claude Code)
 - **Google** - Gemini series
 - **Alibaba Cloud** - Qwen Cloud, Tongyi Qianwen
 - **DeepSeek** - DeepSeek models
 - **Zhipu AI** - GLM models

- **Moonshot** - Kimi + Kimi Coding
- **Ollama** - Local models (cloud + local)
- And many other service providers
- You can freely choose a model service provider based on your actual needs and network policies in your region, and register and apply for API-KEY on the corresponding official website

3. Configure OpenClaw API-KEY

3.1 Configuration Method

OpenClaw provides two methods to configure API-KEY:

1. **CLI command configuration** (suitable for beginners)
2. **Directly modify configuration file** (suitable for developers)
 - Configuration file path: `$HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json`

3.2 Quick Configuration

- The factory preset configuration file has already configured Bailian model parameters; just fill in the API-KEY to use directly
- Open the OpenClaw configuration file:

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
```

3.2.1 Configure baseUrl

- Overseas users should select the corresponding baseUrl according to their service region (go to [ModelStudio Console](#) homepage, switch to the target region in the upper right corner, such as **Singapore**, then select **API Key** in the left navigation bar to create an API Key)

```
Base URL for the region where the API key belongs:
Singapore: https://dashscope-intl.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1
US (Virginia): https://dashscope-us.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1
```

3.2.2 Fill in apiKey

```
"models": {
  "mode": "merge",
  "providers": {
    "bailian": {
      "baseUrl": "https://dashscope.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1",
      "apiKey": "sk-a87e1137b17b4a35af13aa4a12ac3473",
```

- After filling in, press `Ctrl+X`, then press `Y` to confirm save, and press Enter to exit

4. View Connected Model Status

4.1 View Configured Model List

After configuration, you can use the following command to view the connected models:

```
openclaw models list
```

```
pi@raspberrypi:~$ openclaw models list
🐉 OpenClaw 2026.3.12 (6472949) - Your second brain, except this one actually remembers where you left things.

14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_chat: Registered feishu_chat, feishu_chat_members
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_im: Registered feishu_im_user_message, feishu_im_user_fetch_resource, feishu_im_user_get_messages, feishu_im_user_get_thread_message
s, feishu_im_user_search_messages
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_search: Registered feishu_search_doc_wiki
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_drive: Registered feishu_drive_file, feishu_doc_comments, feishu_doc_media
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_wiki: Registered feishu_wiki_space, feishu_wiki_space_node
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_sheets: Registered feishu_sheet
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_im: Registered feishu_im_bot_image
14:49:14 [plugins] Registered all OAPI tools (calendar, task, bitable, search, drive, wiki, sheets, im)
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_doc: Registered feishu_fetch_doc, feishu_create_doc, feishu_update_doc
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_oauth: Registered feishu_oauth_tool
14:49:14 [plugins] feishu_oauth_batch_auth: Registered feishu_oauth_batch_auth tool
14:49:14 [plugins] Pi Control extension registered: servo, dht, rgb, oled, delay, camera (direct CLI)
14:49:14 [plugins] pi-control: Feishu config loaded (chatId=oc_55f4a2df0c058ff43c1083a138aa5e18a)

Model          Input  Ctx   Local Auth  Tags
bailian/qwen3.5-plus  text+image 977k  no  yes  default,configured
bailian/MiniMax-M2.5  text      192k  no  yes  configured
bailian/glm-4.7       text      198k  no  yes  configured
```

4.2 Verify Configuration Success

1. Test conversation

```
openclaw tui
```

Start the TUI interface, send a test message (such as "May I have your name?"), and confirm the model can respond normally.

```
May I have your name

My name is 小亚 (Xiao Ya).

I'm your robot assistant, running on OpenClaw with a physical body equipped
with servos, sensors, RGB lights, OLED display, and a camera. I'm here to help
you with hardware control, vision tasks, and various smart applications.

Nice to meet you! 🤖
connected | idle
agent main | session main (openclaw-tui) | bailian/qwen3.5-plus | tokens
41k/1.0m (4%)
```

5. Other Access Methods (Advanced)

- If you have your own model provider or need to access other model providers later, refer to the following tutorials

5.1 CLI Command Configuration API-KEY (Suitable for Beginners)

1. Start configuration wizard

```
openclaw onboard
```

- Select **【Yes】** and press Enter

```
Recommended baseline:
- Pairing/allowlists + mention gating.
- Multi-user/shared inbox: split trust boundaries (separate gateway/credentials, ideally separate OS users/hosts).
- Sandbox + least-privilege tools.
- Shared inboxes: isolate DM sessions (`session.dmScope: per-channel-peer`) and keep tool access minimal.
- Keep secrets out of the agent's reachable filesystem.
- Use the strongest available model for any bot with tools or untrusted inboxes.

Run regularly:
openclaw security audit --deep
openclaw security audit --fix

Must read: https://docs.openclaw.ai/gateway/security

◆ I understand this is personal-by-default and shared/multi-user use requires lock-down. Continue?
  ● Yes / ○ No
```

- Select QuickStart for configuration mode, press Enter

```
◆ Setup mode
  ● QuickStart (Configure details later via openclaw configure.)
  ○ Manual
```

2. Select model service provider

- Use up and down arrows to select the service provider you have applied for API-KEY, press Enter to confirm. Here we take the Alibaba Cloud Bailian model provider as an example. The configuration method for other model providers is the same.
- Here select custom provider **【Custom Provider】**

```
◆ Model/auth provider

Search:
  ○ Alibaba Model Studio
  ○ Anthropic
  ○ Arcee AI
  ○ BytePlus
  ○ Chutes
  ○ Cloudflare AI Gateway
  ○ Copilot
  ● Custom Provider (Any OpenAI or Anthropic compatible endpoint)
```

- Fill in the base_url of the model provider

```
◆ API Base URL
  https://dashscope.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1
```

3. Input API-KEY

- After selecting the service provider, the system will prompt you to enter the corresponding API-KEY

```
◆ How do you want to provide this API key?  
  ● Paste API key now (Stores the key directly in OpenClaw config)  
  ○ Use external secret provider
```

- Paste or enter your applied API-KEY and press Enter to confirm

```
◆ API Key (leave blank if not required)  
  sk-a87e1137b17b4a35af13aa4a1xxxxxx
```

- Select **OpenAI-compatible** for the interface protocol

```
◆ Endpoint compatibility  
  ● OpenAI-compatible (Uses /chat/completions)  
  ○ Anthropic-compatible  
  ○ Unknown (detect automatically)
```

4. Fill in the model name, here we take MiniMax as an example

```
◆ Model ID  
  MiniMax-M2.5
```

- **Endpoint ID** is the model provider identifier, you can fill in freely

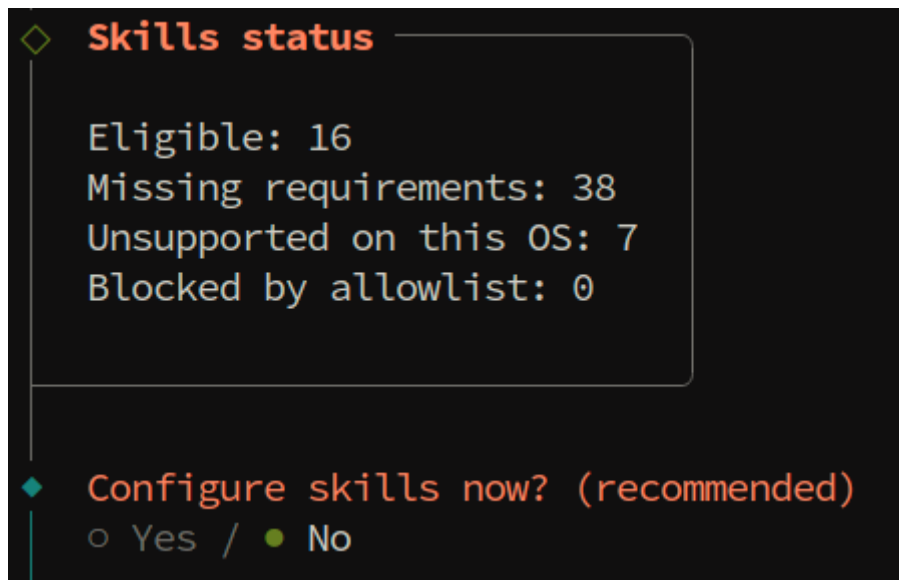
```
◆ Endpoint ID  
  custom-dashscope-aliyuncs-com
```

- Model alias (optional) can be left blank

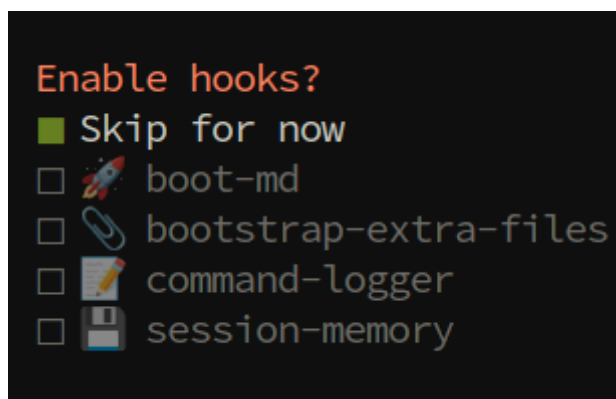
```
◆ Model alias (optional)  
  e.g. local, ollama
```

5. Other configurations

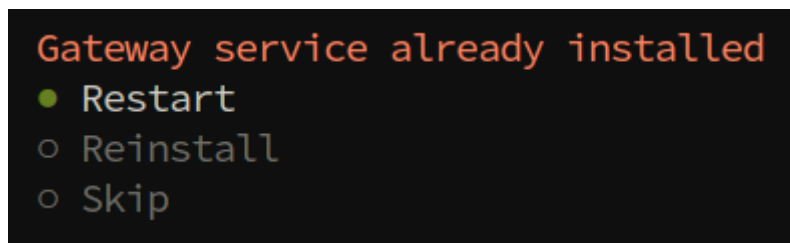
- For other configuration items, select skip as shown in the figure below, no configuration needed



- Press space to select **Skip for now** for Enable Hooks



- Select Restart to restart the gateway to take effect



5.2 Modify Configuration File (Recommended Method)

Configuration File Location

The configuration file is located at: `$HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json`

Edit Configuration File

1. Open the configuration file

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json  
# Or use your favorite editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

2. Add model provider configuration

Add or modify the `models.providers` section in the configuration file:

```
{
```

```

"models": {
  "providers": {
    "openai": {
      "apiKey": "OPENAI_API_KEY"
    },
    "anthropic": {
      "apiKey": "ANTHROPIC_API_KEY"
    },
    "google": {
      "apiKey": "GOOGLE_API_KEY"
    }
  }
},
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "openai/gpt-4"
    }
  }
}
}

```

3. Configuration Description

- `models.providers`: Configure API-KEY for each model service provider
 - `openai.apiKey`: OpenAI's API-KEY
 - `anthropic.apiKey`: Anthropic's API-KEY
 - `google.apiKey`: Google's API-KEY
- `agents.defaults.model.primary`: Set the default model to use
 - Format is `service provider/model name`, such as `openai/gpt-4`, `anthropic/claude-3`, `google/gemini-pro`

4. Save and Exit

- Press `Ctrl+O` to save, `Ctrl+X` to exit (nano editor)

5. Factory Default Bailian Configuration (can be directly modified or referenced)

```

"models": {
  "mode": "merge",
  "providers": {
    "bailian": {
      "baseUrl": "https://dashscope.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1",
      "apiKey": "sk-a98b519b6bab4e35a7b82b4a95b8a4f6",
      "api": "openai-completions",
      "models": [
        {
          "id": "qwen3.5-plus",
          "name": "qwen3.5-plus",
          "reasoning": false,
          "input": [
            "text",
            "image"
          ],
          "contextwindow": 1000000,
          "maxTokens": 65536,
          "cost": {

```

```

        "input": 0,
        "output": 0,
        "cacheRead": 0,
        "cachewrite": 0
    },
    {
        "id": "MiniMax-M2.5",
        "name": "MiniMax-M2.5",
        "reasoning": false,
        "input": [
            "text"
        ],
        "cost": {
            "input": 0,
            "output": 0,
            "cacheRead": 0,
            "cachewrite": 0
        },
        "contextwindow": 196608,
        "maxTokens": 32768
    },
    {
        "id": "glm-4.7",
        "name": "glm-4.7",
        "reasoning": false,
        "input": [
            "text"
        ],
        "cost": {
            "input": 0,
            "output": 0,
            "cacheRead": 0,
            "cachewrite": 0
        },
        "contextwindow": 202752,
        "maxTokens": 16384,
        "compat": {
            "thinkingFormat": "qwen"
        }
    }
]
}

```

6. Common Problems and Solutions

6.1 API-KEY Invalid or Error

Problem: After configuration, it shows API-KEY invalid or authentication failed

Solution:

1. Confirm whether the API-KEY is correct (note no extra spaces)
2. Check if the API-KEY has expired or been disabled
3. Confirm whether the account balance is sufficient (some service providers require pre-charging)

6.2 Cannot Access Model Service

Problem: Configuration is correct but cannot connect to model service

Solution:

1. Check if the network connection is normal
2. Confirm whether the network in your region can access the service provider (some services may require special network configuration)
3. Try changing to another model service provider for testing

7. Course Summary

Through this course, you have mastered:

- ☒ Types of model service providers supported by OpenClaw
- ☒ API-KEY application method and precautions
- ☒ CLI command configuration method (suitable for beginners)
- ☒ Configuration file modification method (suitable for developers)
- ☒ How to view and verify model configuration status
- ☒ Troubleshooting and solutions for common problems